

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting March 3rd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZpChG7DSc9c
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Delaware County Board of Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: March 3, 2025

Presiding Officer: President Henry

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Board of Commissioners was called to order at 9:00 a.m. on Monday, March 3, 2025, by President Henry.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner Stephen Brand, Commissioner Shannon Henry (President), and Commissioner Sherry Reagan.
 - **Absent:** None.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings & Employee Recognitions:**

- **Employees of the Month:** Recognitions were presented for newly expanded employee programs.
 - *Heather Stanley* (Prosecutor's Office / Justice Center investigator, 21 years of service).
 - *Kei Ethel* (County Auditor's Department).
- **Certifications & Professional Milestones:**
 - John (Emergency Management Director) and Cory (Deputy Director) recognized for obtaining their Professional Emergency Manager (PEM) certifications.
 - Fred Cummings recognized for graduating from the Ball State University Certified Public Manager Phase 1 program.
 - Chris King recognized for completing the Registered Public Safety Leader program, bringing 911 dispatch training to a National Standard via APCO International (making Delaware County a state leader).
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - The minutes of the February 18, 2025 meeting were approved with multiple corrections (including spelling fixes for bza appointee Christy Napier/Krisi Knap and Invenergy, noting the table disposition of the dcpd contract, adding the new Norm agreement for Jamie Bane, and correcting a crown castle letter reference) on a roll-call vote (Passed Unanimously).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:10:54 Meridian Health Services Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Stephen Brand / Commissioner Sherry Reagan.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed filling an open seat on the 15-member (previously 14, an even number) Meridian Health Services board, which receives statutory county funding (approx. \$700,000 annually).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Commissioner Reagan was appointed to serve a one-year term on the Meridian board. **Passed Unanimously** (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **00:12:01 Delaware County Prevention Council Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board noted inconsistent meeting schedules and a lack of clear documentation regarding whether this is a commissioner appointment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled to gather more information. **Approved by Voice Vote** (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **00:13:15 Creed Board Appointment Correction**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand / Legal Counsel John Brooke.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed clarifying the appointment of David Williams to the Creed board, noting a requirement to represent union interests.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Placed back on the table for further vetting. **Approved by Voice Vote** (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **00:14:19 Employee Handbook Revisions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Progress update on comprehensive handbook revisions. Committee meetings are ongoing to finalize updates.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Removed from the table for discussion and immediately re-tabled for final approval at the next meeting. **Approved by Voice Vote** (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **00:16:22 Solar Ordinance & Economic Development Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Stephen Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brand reported on meetings with National Grid Renewables (acquired by Brookfield Asset Management) and public feedback. Stressed that economic development agreements (EDAs) should be established prior to permitting. Also touched upon small modular reactors (SMRs) and county special use standards (Article 31).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Removed from the table for discussion and re-tabled. **Approved by Voice Vote** (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **00:17:13 / 00:23:12 Economic Development Services Agreement (East Central Indiana Regional Planning District / ECI / dcpd)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth Rowray / ECI representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented proposals for continuing international economic development services (maintaining a pipeline for foreign investment, including projects like Canpack, and handling future staffing additions). Commissioners questioned funding sources, referencing Edit Plan Project 3 and 4 funds, and coordination with the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission (DCRC).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with instructions to coordinate funding with the DCRC. **Passed Unanimously** (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **01:08:59 2025 Aerial Imagery Funding Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kyle Johnson, Chief Information Officer (GIS).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested \$4,000 as a partner contribution to cover Delaware County's share of the 2025 aerial photo project (\$93,000+ total contract with Pictometry/EagleView), which is 80% reimbursable through a GIS non-reverting fund shared with the Plan Commission.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved, with funding to be identified within EDIT plans. **Passed Unanimously** (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **01:11:59 AT&T Ethernet Contract Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Fluke, IT Department.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Renewal of a 60-month AT&T contract for SWIS ethernet connectivity across 11 county facilities (\$5,454.78/month; \$65,457.36/year) with no price increase from the 2020 baseline. Must be signed by July 17, 2025.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. **Passed Unsinously** (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **01:14:58 Indiana Public Works (IPW) Service Contract (Justice Center Wet Well)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand / Zach Crow (IPW).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed ongoing maintenance issues at the Justice Center sewer wet well and "muffin monster" grinder system, including moisture damage/corrosion inside the electrical control panel. Proposed a recurring monthly service agreement (approx. \$1,100/month) alongside immediate pump replacements and control panel relocations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved initial 3-month service agreement. **Passed Unanimously** (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **01:19:33 Corson Fire and Security Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Fluke / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed automatic renewal clauses and reviewed 2024 service reports pending a 2025 updated proposal.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled pending direct meetings and updated pricing. **Approved by Voice Vote** (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
- **01:28:28 Resolution of the Delaware County Board of Commissioners Establishing Meeting Decorum**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Legal Counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed a resolution updating public meeting rules to comply with new state statutes. Amended language regarding statutory allowance (Section B), public comment periods (Section C), and clarified that speaking time may not be yielded to others (Section I). Addressed sheriff enforcement guidelines regarding warnings (up to 3 warnings).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved pending specified language changes. **Passed** (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Reagan - No, Henry - Yes).
- **01:36:39 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of general county claims. Commissioner Brand noted improved descriptions compared to prior meetings, though highlighted items such as in-keeper taxes (\$60k), credit card claims without descriptions (\$17k), wet well repairs/muffin monster (\$35k), surveyor drainage (\$118k), and wheel tax disbursements (\$123k).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Claims batch 1 (\\$1,476,260.40 approx): Approved (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - No, Henry - Yes).

- Claims batch 2 (\\$35,320 approx): Approved **Passed Unanimously** (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
 - **01:40:01 Payment of Payroll**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of payroll for pay period ending February 26, 2025. Noted as error-free.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved. **Passed Unanimously** (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes).
 - **01:49:17 Take-Home Vehicle Policy Eligibility Language**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Stephen Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed formalizing criteria for county take-home vehicles (requiring Delaware County residency, regular after-hours travel at least twice a week, and documenting call-outs averaging at least 8 times a month). Emergency vehicles (Sheriff, 911, EMS, EMA with forward red lights) were exempted from these specific mileage/call-out thresholds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted into policy for review at the upcoming handbook committee meeting. **Passed Unanimously** (Roll Call: Reagan - Yes, Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:40:48 Linda Hansen** (1400 West North Street, speaking for the League of Women Voters): Inquired about the timeline and participants for the upcoming special meeting with the Metropolitan Planning Commission regarding the solar ordinance (targeted for April 3, with a 10-day public notice window).
 - **01:42:43 Cheryl Dawson** (State Road 28 and Wheeling Avenue): Spoke regarding the solar project map, setbacks, and raised concerns regarding potential eminent domain applications if project ownership transfers to public utilities.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - State of the City address scheduled for Thursday, 7:00 a.m. - 9:00 a.m. at the Horizon Convention Center.
 - Don Chambers hired as the new County Building Superintendent.
 - Ongoing tariff rate reviews for county electrical meters to identify cost savings.
 - Justice Center front parking lot paving scheduled for late April (pending asphalt plant openings).
 - **Retirement Recognition:** Commissioners honored **Angie Moyer**, who is stepping down after 29 years of dedicated service in bringing millions in grant dollars to

Delaware County. A retirement reception is scheduled for next Monday from 1:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m. at the Highway Department.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was recessed/adjourned following a motion by Commissioner Reagan, seconded by Commissioner Brand, and approved unanimously on a roll-call vote (01:57:54).

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